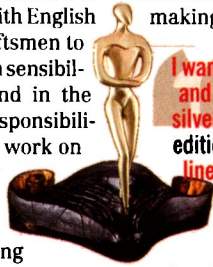


mersed in County English culture, with designs that were expressly Period. But Chandaa felt that the skills of the 200 Indian workmen at F&H could be better explored within the Indian idiom. While she continued to encourage F&H to grow with English motifs, she asked her craftsmen to blend eastern and western sensibilities in their designs. And in the midst of her corporate responsibilities, she kept up with her work on sculptures and, in July 2007, held her first exhibition in Bangalore.

At the same time, Narang was growing increasingly discontent that painstakingly crafted F&H designs were being valued by customers only as commercial objects. "I wanted to explore 3-D art in India and make a whole age of art in silver. That's how I got the idea of making

limited edition pieces," she says. Launched in December last year, the FH Art line features 21 pieces of each design, handcrafted in several metals. "It has many large works, which means a lot of genius has gone into making them," says Narang.



I want to explore 3-D art in India and make a whole age of art in silver. That's why I made limited edition sculptures for the FH Art line, launched last December.

CHANDAA NARANG,
CEO, Frazer and Haws

The FH gallery, housed within the F&H campus, has a rustic appeal. Mud-walled, with sack-cloth curtains, it has sculptures inspired by Indian mythology and a few of Narang's artworks in pastels, crayons, acrylic, pencil and

charcoal. A brass sculpture of a mother eagle nurturing her eggs vies for attention with a silver vase. Then there's a silver teapot with roosters on the lid and a candle stand which is an artistic take on Goddess Durga.

Says actor and artist Suchitra Krishnamoorthy, who exhibited her works with Narang in Bangalore: "Chandaa's works have an emotional appeal. She knows her materials very well and brings the same level of craftsmanship into her art as she does in her silverware. I find her manner of blending terracotta with silver very unique." With some works from the FH Art line already having found homes for themselves, Narang now plans to take her collection to London in April this year. Also

on the cards are plans for a sculpture exhibition in Mumbai. ■ by Newly Paul

